

Tanks and tracks



Renault FT-17 France 1917

Stabilizer prevents tank from tipping over backward

Turret hatch, below which tank commander sits



Panzerkampfwagen IV Germany 1936

Turret holds three of the five crew members

T-34/85
Soviet Union 1941



Large gun can fire shells more than 3 miles (5 km)

Tough armor made of ceramics and metals



CHALLENGER 1 MBT



9ft 8 in (3 m) tall

Tanks are heavily armored vehicles that run on tracks so they can cross muddy ground and other difficult terrain. They are usually equipped with a powerful, shell-firing artillery gun. The first tanks saw service in World War I.

The **Mark V** had an eight-man crew and a top speed of 5 mph (8km/h), the same as the two-man **Renault FT-17**—the first tank with a rotating gun turret. The **Panzerkampfwagen IV**'s powerful gun could pierce the armor of other tanks. It had a top speed of 24 mph